THE PROBLEM

Your version control assumes one human, one change

Git's whole model was built around how people write code, not how agents do

- One person, one branch, one change at a time
- Commits assume a human decided this diff matters
- That assumption breaks the moment an agent is writing

WHY THIS IS BLOWING UP

Anthropic just wrote about hitting this wall

Their engineering team described agents producing parallel attempts Git wasn't designed to hold

- An agent can generate dozens of attempts in minutes
- Each one is a large diff, not a small human edit
- The post triggered 950+ comments in a day

THE MECHANISM

The unit of 'change' is the real issue

Git tracks line-by-line diffs. Agents produce whole rewrites and re-rewrites

- A commit implies intent behind every line
- Agent output is often exploratory, not intentional
- Reviewing 10 parallel attempts isn't a normal PR review

WHAT BREAKS FIRST

Review, not code, is the bottleneck

Writing code got faster. Judging code didn't

- Humans can't meaningfully review 10x the diff volume
- Branch-per-attempt doesn't scale past a few options
- Merge conflicts multiply when agents iterate fast

WHAT TEAMS ARE TRYING

Treat agent output as drafts, not commits

The shift is separating generation from the decision to keep something

- Let agents produce many attempts outside the main history
- Only promote an attempt to a commit after it's chosen
- Keep a human or a scoring step as the gate, not the diff tool

A LESSON WORTH KEEPING

Speed without a filter just creates more noise

More code generated isn't progress if nobody can evaluate it

- Agent speed is only useful with a fast decision step after it
- The bottleneck moves from writing to deciding what's good
- Tooling needs to support judgment, not just output

PRACTICAL TAKEAWAY

Design the review step before the agent step

If you're using agents to write code, build the filter first

- Define what 'good enough to commit' means before you generate
- Separate exploration space from your actual commit history
- Give someone or something a clear way to approve or reject fast

CTA

How is your team reviewing agent-written code?

Curious what's actually working as the volume goes up

- Still doing manual PR review on agent output?
- Using any kind of scoring or filtering step first?
- Happy to compare notes on what's holding up

Lark AI Agency | Paul Charles